

James Russo

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🔗 <https://jamesrusso12.github.io/Portfolio-2.0>

Gameplay and XR developer who ships. Solo-built a mixed reality shooter for Meta Quest 3 holding a stable 72 FPS with hand tracking and passthrough, and owned the ARKit pipeline for an accessible iOS app delivered to a university partner program. Works in Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Unity 6/C#, and SwiftUI, with an interaction design background that carries into comfort tuning and playtest-driven iteration.

PROJECTS

Ghost Defiant | Mixed Reality Shooter, Unity 6, C#, Meta Quest 3 2025

- Solo-developed an MR ghost-hunting shooter over an 8-month capstone; selected for the Boise State senior showcase
- Built custom debris and impact physics plus spatial audio and fog VFX tuned for passthrough legibility
- Designed hand-tracking-first interaction (grab thresholds, haptics, spatial reticle) and a diegetic comfort HUD

Bookshelf Adventures | iOS AR Reading App, SwiftUI, ARKit 2025

- Owned the ARKit pipeline (page image recognition, 3D model placement, real-time tracking) for an accessible reader built with Mississippi State University's special-needs department and delivered for student use

Unreal Engine 5 Prototypes | Blueprints 2024 – 2025

- 2D fighter with AI combat and combo systems; multiplayer target range with replicated scoring and hit detection

WORK EXPERIENCE

Technical Specialist, Genius Bar 07/2026 – Present
Apple Inc., Boise

- Orchestrated frontline diagnostics and triage, prioritizing cases by severity within a full appointment queue
- Diagnosed iOS and macOS hardware and software failures, explaining root causes and fixes at every skill level
- Systematically documented case histories and coordinated escalations to the hardware repair team

Retail Specialist 08/2025 – 06/2026
Apple Inc., Boise

- Translated user needs into tailored technical solutions through hands-on demos and guided onboarding
- Diagnosed and resolved hardware and software issues while clearly communicating root cause and resolution

Lead Interaction Designer (Freelance) 02/2022 – 08/2023
Boise State University, Boise

- Led interaction design and usability testing for a live student finance web app, from user flows to high-fidelity UI

EDUCATION

B.S., Games, Interactive Media & Mobile Technologies 08/2021 – 12/2025
Boise State University, Boise

SKILLS

Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints)	Unity 6	C#
Swift/SwiftUI	ARKit	Meta XR All-in-One SDK
VR/MR: Quest, Vision Pro	Hand tracking, passthrough	Spatial audio
Comfort tuning, VR/MR HUDs	Frame-rate profiling	Bug repro, regression testing
Rapid prototyping	Figma, Blender	Git/GitHub

CERTIFICATES

XR Developer Program Certificate, Boise State University GIMM 05/2025

Unreal Engine Fundamentals, Epic Games via Coursera 04/2026

Unreal Engine Blueprints, Epic Games via Coursera

Introduction to Game Design, Epic Games via Coursera 01/2026